



Complete User Manual

Simple, powerful desktop accounting for Indian businesses.

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A product of AI Consultants

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Upgrade your plan: apps.ai-consultants.in/upgrade.html

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Contents

Right-click here and choose "Update Field" to build the contents list.

1. About this manual

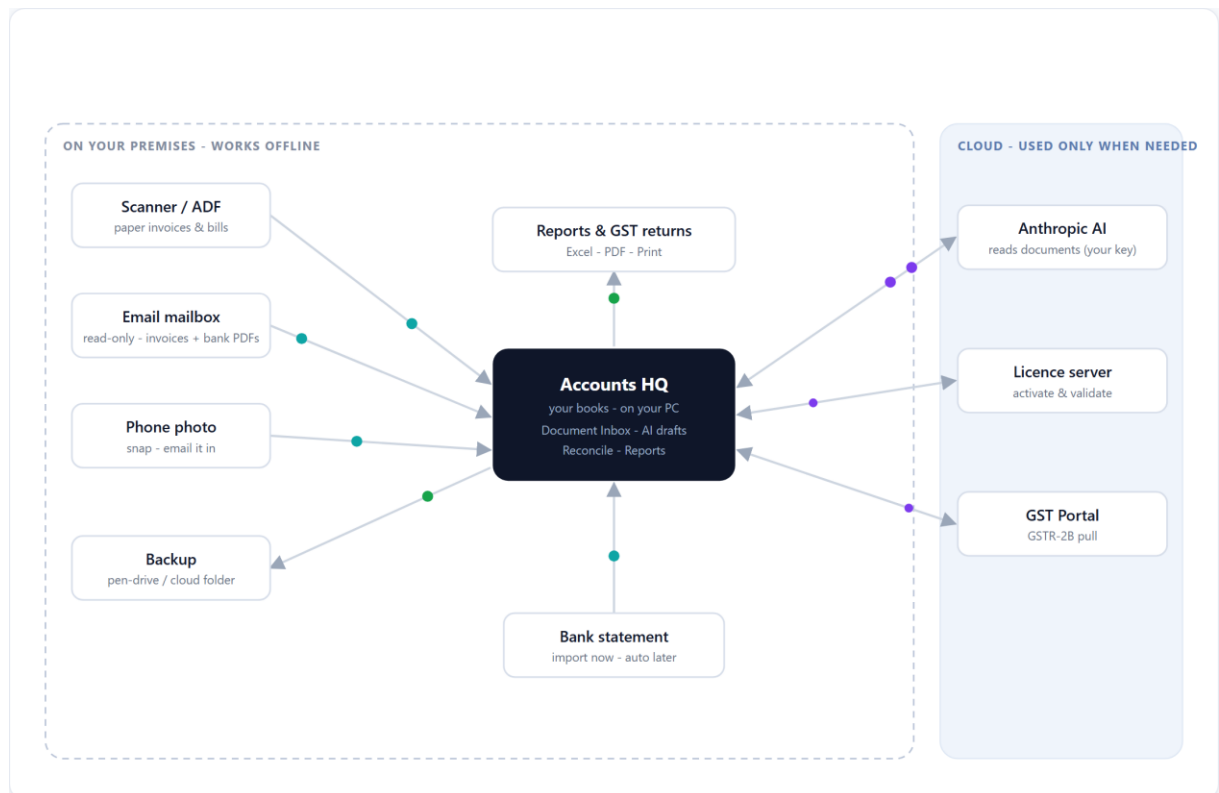
This manual explains everything you need to run Accounts HQ, written for everyday business owners and staff - not just accountants. You do not need an accounting background to follow it. Wherever a technical term appears, it is explained in plain English, and there is a full glossary at the end (section 28).

How to use it

- If you are brand new, read section 2 (accounting basics) and section 4 (your first 10 minutes) first.
- If you just want to do one task, use the Contents page to jump to it.
- Boxes marked TIP, NOTE and EXAMPLE give shortcuts, warnings and worked illustrations.

NOTE: Some features are only available on certain plans (Standard, Pro, Premium). Each section says which plan it needs. See section 26 for plans.

Featured: Two ways to keep books - and why the modern way wins



How Accounts HQ connects: your documents and bank flow in, the books live on your PC, and cloud services are used only when you choose to.

The conservative way - "record, then report"

For decades, books have been kept like this: documents (invoices, bills, bank statements) pile up in files and inboxes. Then a skilled person sits down - usually at month-end - and types every transaction into a voucher, one by one. That typing is the bottleneck. Bank reconciliation is done line by line. Outstanding amounts are tracked in the head or in side registers. Cash planning, if done at all, is gut feel or a separate Excel sheet. Reports are produced in a scramble at the end of the period.

The result: the books are real, but they are weeks behind reality; effort spikes at month-end; every entry needs accounting skill; and manual typing breeds errors. The person is, in effect, a data-entry clerk.

The modern way - "capture, draft, approve, live books"

With the AI Document Inbox and email feeder, bill-by-bill tracking, live aging and the assisted cash-flow planner, the job changes shape:

- Documents flow in continuously - your mailbox is read for invoice attachments, the scanner drops into one folder, and a phone photo is just an email. Nothing piles up.
- AI reads each document, decides what it is, and drafts the voucher. The person no longer types - they review the draft against the document and approve it. The bottleneck is gone.
- Settling an invoice is a single click ("Allocate to bills", auto-filled oldest first).
- Because every document is captured as it arrives, receivables, payables, aging and the cash forecast are always current - not rebuilt at month-end.
- Month-end stops being a marathon: the books are already done, so you simply file GST and pull reports.

The result: the books stay current every day, the person becomes a reviewer / controller rather than a clerk, errors drop, and effort is a steady trickle instead of a monthly spike.

In one sentence: the shift is from "type everything first, see the picture later" to "documents come in, AI drafts, you approve - and the picture is always live."

Side by side

- **Getting documents in** - *Old*: pile up, fetched at month-end **Now**: auto-arrive continuously into one Inbox
- **Data entry** - *Old*: a person types every voucher (the bottleneck) **Now**: AI drafts, you approve - no typing
- **Skill per entry** - *Old*: accounting knowledge each time **Now**: judgment to approve; AI does the mechanics
- **Timeliness** - *Old*: books weeks behind **Now**: current every day
- **Outstanding / aging** - *Old*: memory or side registers **Now**: live, including bill-by-bill
- **Bank reconciliation** - *Old*: line-by-line by hand **Now**: statement flows in, assisted matching
- **Cash planning** - *Old*: gut feel or a side Excel **Now**: assisted forecast - plan the big 80%

- **Reporting** - *Old*: a period-end scramble **Now**: a live dashboard plus one click
- **Shape of the effort** - *Old*: a monthly spike **Now**: a steady daily trickle

The new workflow - a rhythm, not a marathon

Every day (about 10 minutes)

1. Open the Document Inbox. New invoices and bills are already there - pulled from email, dropped by the scanner, or added by you.
2. For each: glance at the document, click "Process with AI", check the draft, and Accept & Post. For a customer/supplier bill, click "Allocate to bills" (one click - oldest first is filled in).
3. Glance at the Home dashboard: Cash & Bank, Receivables, Payables, Net this month.

Every week (about 15 minutes)

4. Bank Reconciliation - bring in the week's statement and match it off.
5. Cash-Flow Planning - for any new big receipt or payment, tick the fortnight you expect it; read the projected cash position and act on anything shown in red.
6. Chase the 90+ column in Receivables Aging.

At month or quarter end (now easy)

7. There is no data-entry backlog - the books are already current. Just open the GST returns and the reports you need.

In short: bookkeeping becomes a short, continuous review habit instead of a periodic typing project. That is the real change Accounts HQ brings.

2. Accounting basics in plain English

Accounts HQ keeps your books using "double-entry" - the standard, trusted method. You do not have to understand the theory to use the app, but a few words will help.

- **LEDGER** - an account you track money in or against. Examples: "Cash", "HDFC Bank", "Rent", "Sales", and one ledger per customer or supplier (e.g. "Acme Traders").
- **GROUP** - a folder that organises ledgers. For example all your customers sit in the "Sundry Debtors" group; all suppliers in "Sundry Creditors". Accounts HQ creates the standard groups for you.
- **VOUCHER** - a single recorded transaction (a payment, a sale, a receipt, etc.). Every time money or value moves, you record one voucher.
- **DEBIT (Dr) and CREDIT (Cr)** - the two sides of every voucher. They must always be equal. Accounts HQ balances them for you on most screens, so you rarely think about it.
- **RECEIVABLE** - money customers owe you. **PAYABLE** - money you owe suppliers.

TIP: You can change how Dr/Cr are worded (plain / traditional / accounting) in Settings if the words confuse you - see section 25.

3. Installing Accounts HQ

8. Double-click the installer file (named "Accounts HQ-Setup-x.x.x.exe", where x.x.x is the version).
9. If Windows shows a security prompt, choose to run it (the app is safe).
10. Choose the folder to install into (the default is fine for most people) and click through to Finish.
11. A shortcut named "Accounts HQ" is added to your Start menu / desktop.

NOTE: Accounts HQ runs on Windows. Your company data is stored on this same PC. It is NOT automatically copied to the cloud, so backups (section 24) are your safety net.

4. Your first 10 minutes

This is the fastest way to get going.

Step 1 - Open the app and create a company

12. Open Accounts HQ. After the splash screen you see the Company selector.
13. Click New Company.
14. Type your business name. Add your GSTIN and state if you are GST-registered (this makes GST calculate correctly). Set the financial-year start (usually 1 April).
15. Click Create. Accounts HQ builds a full chart of accounts for you automatically.

Step 2 - Land on Home

The app opens on the Home dashboard. At the top-left is the Accounts HQ logo - clicking it always brings you back here. You will see tiles for Cash & Bank, Receivables, Payables and Net this month, plus your recent activity and quick-action buttons.

Step 3 - Record your first transaction

16. Click Post Voucher (in the Transactions section of the sidebar, or the Home quick action).
17. Pick a type - for example Receipt if a customer paid you.
18. Choose the two accounts and type the amount, then click Post.

EXAMPLE: A customer paid you Rs. 5,000 in cash. Choose Receipt, set "Received from" to the customer, "Deposited to" to Cash, amount 5000, and Post. Done.

Step 4 - See your books

Open Day Book to see the voucher you just posted, or Trial Balance / Profit & Loss under Reports. That is the whole loop: record vouchers, read reports.

The Quick Setup wizard

The first time you open a company, a Quick Setup wizard runs automatically. It walks you through the optional settings - look and feel, your business details, GST and AI - and for each one explains why it helps and what it takes, so you can set it up or skip it.

You can run it again any time from the gear “Setup” button in the status bar, or from the tile menu under Settings > Quick Setup. If you upgrade your plan it re-opens to help you switch on what the new plan unlocks.

5. The main window explained

The sidebar (left)

Everything is reached from the sidebar, grouped into collapsible sections. Click a section heading to open or close it:

- TRANSACTIONS - Post Voucher, Day Book, Ledger Balances, Verbal Entry.
- REPORTS - Trial Balance, P&L, Balance Sheet, Cash/Bank Book, Ledger Account, Receipts & Payments, Receivables Aging, Payables Aging, Bill-wise Outstanding, Cash-Flow Planning.
- TAX - GST returns and TDS reports (Pro and above).
- RECONCILIATION - Bank and Ledger reconciliation (Standard and above).
- AI - Document Inbox and AI Document Reader (Pro and above).
- DATA - Backup & Restore, Migration, Period Locks.
- ACCOUNT - your Licence, settings and feedback.

Two ways to navigate: sidebar or tile menu

Accounts HQ gives you two navigation styles - pick the one you prefer in Settings.

Sidebar - the list of screens down the left (described above). You can hide it with the toggle in the status bar to free up space.

Tile menu - press the “Menu” button in the status bar for a full-screen grid of every screen, grouped into Accounting, Reports, Tools and Settings, with your most-recent screens at the top. Click a tile to jump there.

The status bar (bottom of the window)

The bar along the bottom is always visible, even when the sidebar is hidden:

Menu - opens the tile launcher.

Sidebar toggle - shows or hides the left sidebar.

Setup (gear) - re-runs the Quick Setup wizard.

AI Credits - your AI balance; click it to open the wallet and top up.

The logo, Home and tools

- Click the app logo to return to the Home dashboard at any time.
- Dark / Light mode - toggle at the bottom of the sidebar (above "Switch Company").
- Switch Company - change to another company file.

- Calculator - press Alt+C any time.

6. Your chart of accounts (groups and ledgers)

When you created the company, Accounts HQ added the standard groups and common ledgers (Cash, Sales, Purchases, GST ledgers, and so on), mirroring Tally Prime. You add your own ledgers as you go - one per customer, supplier, bank account, expense head, etc.

Adding a ledger

You can create a ledger on the spot while entering a voucher: start typing the name in the account box; if it does not exist yet, you are prompted to add it under the right group (for a customer choose "Sundry Debtors", a supplier "Sundry Creditors", a bank "Bank Accounts", an expense the relevant expense group).

TIP: Keep customer and supplier names consistent (one ledger per party) so their statements and aging stay accurate.

7. Recording transactions - the basics

Post Voucher is where you record everything. At the top you pick the voucher type; the form then shows exactly the fields that type needs.

The smart entry form

19. Pick the voucher type (the eight types are explained in section 8).
20. Fill the two account boxes. The labels tell you what goes where - for a Receipt they read "Received from" and "Deposited to".
21. Enter the amount. For Sales/Purchase/Notes a GST box appears - pick the rate (e.g. 18%) and Accounts HQ adds CGST+SGST (same state) or IGST (other state) automatically.
22. Optionally add a narration (a note) and a reference (e.g. the invoice or cheque number).
23. Click Post. Accounts HQ checks the entry balances, assigns the next voucher number, and saves it. A confirmation appears.

NOTE: The balance strip at the bottom shows Dr and Cr totals and a green "Balanced" tick so you can see the entry is valid before you post.

8. The eight voucher types, with examples

Payment

Money going out of your bank or cash.

EXAMPLE: Paid Rs. 12,000 office rent from HDFC Bank: Payment, "Paid to" = Rent, "Paid from" = HDFC Bank, amount 12000.

Receipt

Money coming into your bank or cash.

EXAMPLE: Customer Acme paid Rs. 25,000 into your bank: Receipt, "Received from" = Acme, "Deposited to" = HDFC Bank, amount 25000.

Contra

Moving money between your own cash and bank, or between two banks.

EXAMPLE: Deposited Rs. 10,000 cash into the bank: Contra, From = Cash, To = HDFC Bank, 10000.

Journal

Any adjustment that is not a straight payment/receipt - it can have several lines. Use it for depreciation, corrections, opening balances, etc.

Sales

A sales invoice to a customer, with GST handled for you.

EXAMPLE: Sold goods worth Rs. 50,000 + 18% GST to Acme on credit: Sales, party = Acme, income = Sales, base amount 50000, GST 18%. Accounts HQ posts Acme Rs. 59,000 Dr, Sales 50,000 Cr, CGST 4,500 + SGST 4,500 (same state).

Purchase

A purchase bill from a supplier, with GST.

Debit Note / Credit Note

Returns and adjustments. A Debit Note reduces what you owe a supplier (purchase return); a Credit Note reduces what a customer owes you (sales return).

9. Multi-party vouchers (Standard and above)

Use this when ONE bank transaction settles SEVERAL parties at once - for example a payment-gateway settlement that covers many customers.

24. On a Payment or Receipt, click "Multi-party voucher".
25. Add one row per party and its amount; the single bank/cash total auto-sums.
26. Post once - Accounts HQ creates the correct multi-line voucher.

10. Bill-by-bill / "Against Reference" (Pro and above)

Normally Accounts HQ tracks a customer or supplier by their overall balance. Bill-by-bill lets you tie each receipt or payment to specific invoices, so you know exactly which bills are still open and how old each one is.

How it works

27. When you post a Sales or Purchase, Accounts HQ records that invoice as an open "bill" (using your reference / invoice number).
28. When the party pays, open a Receipt (or Payment), choose the party and amount, then click "Allocate to bills...".
29. A box lists the party open bills. The amount is auto-filled oldest-first; adjust how much settles each bill. Anything not allocated posts "on-account" (unapplied).
30. Click Apply, then Post.

You can then see every open invoice, bill by bill, in Reports > Bill-wise Outstanding, including how overdue each one is.

NOTE: This is optional. If you do not click "Allocate to bills...", the receipt simply reduces the party overall balance as usual.

11. Editing and cancelling a voucher

31. Open Day Book and find the voucher (use the date filter or search).
32. Double-click it (or use Edit) to change it, or use Cancel to void it.

Cancelling is a "soft delete" - the voucher is marked cancelled but kept for the audit trail; it no longer affects your balances.

NOTE: A voucher whose bank line has already been reconciled must be un-matched in Bank Reconciliation before you can edit it.

12. Day Book and Ledger Balances

- DAY BOOK - a list of every voucher, with a date filter, search and sort. Edit or cancel from here, and double-click a row to see full detail.
- LEDGER BALANCES - the current balance of every ledger as of a date you choose.

13. Reports

All reports work the same way. Open a report, then use the toolbar at the top:

- Pick the date (or From/To range).
- Type in the search box to filter rows; click a column heading to sort.
- Export with the Excel, PDF or Print buttons.

The reports available

- Trial Balance - every ledger balance, proving the books balance.
- Profit & Loss - income vs expenses for a period; your profit or loss.
- Balance Sheet - assets vs liabilities on a date.

- Cash Book / Bank Book - all cash / bank movements.
- Ledger Account - the full statement of any one ledger (e.g. one customer).
- Receipts & Payments - a summary of money in and out.

14. Receivables and Payables Aging (Standard and above)

"Aging" shows how OLD your outstanding amounts are, split into 0-30, 31-60, 61-90 and 90+ day buckets, so you can chase what is overdue.

- Receivables Aging - what each CUSTOMER owes you, by age.
- Payables Aging - what you owe each SUPPLIER, by age.

TIP: A large 90+ figure is money stuck - the first thing to chase.

15. Bill-wise Outstanding (Pro and above)

If you use bill-by-bill (section 10), this report lists every open invoice one-by-one (not just the party total), with its age. Use the toggle to switch between Receivables (customers) and Payables (suppliers), and export to Excel or PDF.

16. Cash-Flow Planning - assisted (Pro and above)

This is a planning worksheet that helps you see whether you will have enough cash in the coming weeks. It does NOT add any work to your daily entry - your invoices stay exactly as they are.

How to use it

33. Open Reports > Cash-Flow Planning.
34. The top half lists only your BIG open items - the few customers/suppliers that make up about 80% of money coming in and going out. (The many small amounts are handled for you automatically.)
35. For each big item, use the "Expect by" drop-down to tick the fortnight you expect that receipt or payment to actually happen.
36. The bottom half instantly shows your projected cash position, fortnight by fortnight, starting from your current cash & bank balance. Any period where you would run short is shown in red.

EXAMPLE: You know your biggest customer always pays around mid-next-month - tick that fortnight for them. The forecast then shows the cash arriving then, and whether you can cover the supplier payment due before it.

NOTE: Because you only plan the big items and tick a fortnight (no exact dates, no per-invoice fields), your normal voucher entry - including AI auto-posting - is untouched.

17. GST and TDS (Pro and above)

GST

- GSTR-3B and GSTR-1 - your monthly/quarterly summary and outward-supplies returns.
- HSN Summary - sales grouped by HSN/SAC code.
- GSTR-2B Reconciliation - match the portal 2B against your recorded purchases to spot mismatches and missing input credit.

TDS

- TDS Reports and a section-wise TDS Register - tax deducted at source on eligible payments, using the standard sections and thresholds.

NOTE: Accounts HQ records the figures and prepares the returns. It is not a tax-rules engine - your accountant decides the final filing.

18. Bank and Ledger reconciliation (Standard and above)

Reconciliation means proving that your books agree with an outside record - your bank's statement, or a statement a customer or supplier sent you. You bring that outside statement in, and Accounts HQ helps you tick off ("match") each line against the matching voucher in your books. Anything that does not match is exactly what you need to look at.

Why it matters

Your books are only as trustworthy as the day they last agreed with the bank. Reconciliation catches missing entries (a bank charge you never recorded), duplicates and errors - and tells you your true cash position rather than what you think it is.

Bank reconciliation - step by step

37. Open Reconciliation > Bank Reconciliation and pick the bank ledger (for example HDFC Bank).
38. Bring in the statement. Click Import Statement and choose the file your bank gave you - PDF, Excel or CSV. Accounts HQ reads it on your own PC first (free and instant). Only if that fails does it offer to use AI to read it (for a scanned or image statement), and it always asks you first.
39. It checks the statement is really for this account. Accounts HQ compares the account number on the statement (or, if the file hides it, the bank's name) against the ledger you picked. If they do not match it stops and warns you - so you can never accidentally import HDFC's statement onto your Axis ledger.
40. Pick the period. It defaults to the day after your last reconciliation, up to today, so you carry on exactly where you left off and never double-count.
41. Auto-match runs. Accounts HQ pairs each statement line to the voucher in your books that has the same date, the same amount, and the same direction (money in or money out).

42. You resolve the rest - the handful of lines that did not auto-match (explained below).

43. Finalise. Accounts HQ takes a permanent snapshot of the reconciliation.

NOTE: Auto-match is deliberately cautious. If two lines on the same day are for the same amount (say two payments of Rs. 500), it will NOT guess which is which - it leaves both for you. That way a wrong narration is never stuck on the wrong entry.

The matching screen - what you see

The statement lines are split into tabs so you always know what is left to do:

- Matched - lines already paired to a voucher (by auto-match, by you, or by a voucher you created here). Nothing more to do with these.
- Unmatched - statement lines that have no voucher yet, plus anything you have flagged to come back to. This is your worklist.
- Ignored - lines you have set aside as "not a concern", so they stop cluttering the view but stay on record.

Resolving an unmatched line

For each line in the Unmatched tab you have a few choices:

- Match to an existing voucher - you already recorded it and auto-match simply did not pair it (for example the dates differed by a day). Click Find Candidate and Accounts HQ shows the uncleared vouchers near that date and amount to pick from.
- Create a voucher - the transaction is on the bank but not yet in your books (a bank charge, interest, an auto-debit). Accounts HQ drafts the voucher; you pick the other account (for example Bank Charges) and post - and it is matched in the same step. To save you time on repeats, it even suggests the account you used last time for a similar narration (for example every "JIO" line to Telephone Expenses).
- Ignore - it is not relevant to your books; set it aside.
- Flag - you are not sure yet; mark it to return to later.

NOTE: You can act on many lines at once - for example tick every "JIO" line, choose Telephone Expenses, and create all those vouchers in one go.

Two tricky cases it handles for you

- One bank line that equals several of your entries. A payment-gateway settlement of Rs. 47,000 might cover five separate customer receipts. Use Match (split): pick the several vouchers that together add up to the one bank line - Accounts HQ checks the total agrees before it lets you confirm.
- Cheques not yet cleared. A cheque you have recorded but the bank has not cleared can be marked cleared on its own (with no statement line), so your reconciliation reflects reality.

Finalising - and why it is safe

When the Unmatched tab is clear (or holds only items you have consciously flagged or ignored), click Finalise. Accounts HQ stores a snapshot: your book balance, the bank's closing balance, and how many lines were matched versus left over. You can re-open and reconcile the next period at any time - it remembers where you stopped.

NOTE: Once a voucher's bank line has been reconciled, you must un-match it here before you can edit or cancel that voucher. This protects a finished reconciliation from being changed behind your back.

Ledger reconciliation

Ledger reconciliation works the same way, but against a statement a party sent you (a supplier's "ledger copy", or a customer's account statement) instead of a bank. Open Reconciliation > Ledger Reconciliation, pick the party, bring in their statement, and match it against your ledger for them - so the two of you agree on exactly what is owed before you pay or chase.

19. AI Document Inbox and Reader (Pro / Premium)

Accounts HQ can READ your invoices and bills and DRAFT the vouchers for you, so you stop typing and simply review. It runs on your own Anthropic AI key, so there is no per-document charge from us. This section explains exactly what happens at each step, so you can trust what it produces.

Two tools, two ways of getting AI: the AI Document Reader (open one document, get a draft) uses built-in AI Credits - you do not need your own key, usage is simply metered against your credit balance. The Document Inbox pipeline (email / scan / bulk) uses your own Anthropic key. Both are described below.

AI Credits and top-up

The AI Document Reader is paid for with AI Credits. Your balance shows on the AI Credits button in the status bar; click it to open the wallet and top up by any amount. As a guide, reading one document costs about ₹5 of credits. The Document Inbox uses your own key, so it is billed by your AI provider, not by credits.

The big idea in one line

A document comes in - the AI reads it and writes a draft voucher - you check the draft against the document and approve. You are the reviewer; the AI does the typing.

One-time setup (Document Inbox - your own key)

44. Get an Anthropic API key from console.anthropic.com (it takes a few minutes; the key is on your own account).
45. In Accounts HQ open Settings > AI / Anthropic Key and paste the key. Save.

NOTE: On Pro and Premium we will set this up for you - and connect your email and scanner - as part of your plan. Just ask.

How documents get in (the Inbox)

Open AI > Document Inbox in the sidebar. Everything funnels into ONE inbox folder for the company, and there are three ways a document lands there - all of them end up in the same review queue:

- Email (read-only): the first time, click Connect Email (and the gear button) to point Accounts HQ at a folder or label in your own mailbox; after that, just click Check Email to pull invoice attachments automatically. Your email password is stored only on your PC (scrambled), and the documents never pass through our servers.
- Scanner: point your scanner software at the inbox folder (Open Inbox Folder shows you exactly where it is), then click Scan Folder to bring those files in. A photo you take on your phone and email to yourself counts too.
- Manual: click Add Files and pick files from your PC yourself.

What happens when you click "Process with AI" - step by step

This is the part worth understanding. It happens in two passes.

Pass 1 - Read the document (turn it into text)

First Accounts HQ pulls the words out of the file. It tries the free, instant way on your own PC first, and only uses the paid AI "eyes" if it has to:

- A normal PDF, Excel, CSV or Word file - read directly on your PC. Free, instant, no AI involved.
- A scanned PDF or a photo/image (no selectable text) - it first tries free text-recognition (OCR) on your PC; only if that cannot read it does it send the image to Claude (Anthropic's AI) to read the text. This is the only step that can cost anything, and it happens only for images and scans.

Pass 2 - Understand it and draft the voucher

Now the AI reads that text with the full context of YOUR books. It is given your list of ledgers and your company name, and it works out:

- What the document is - a purchase bill, a sales invoice, a debit or credit note, a bank statement, or "other".
- Who the party is, the date, the invoice or bill number, the amounts, and the GST split.
- Which of YOUR ledgers each amount belongs to - it matches names against your actual chart of accounts, not generic guesses.

From that it writes a complete, balanced draft voucher. For a purchase bill, for example: Dr Purchases (the base amount), Dr Input CGST and SGST (or IGST), Cr the supplier (the gross amount) - with the bill number as the reference.

NOTE: It reads meaning, not column positions. That is why it works across any Indian bank or vendor format, and why a change in someone's layout does not break it.

Reviewing and posting - the exact steps

46. In the Document Inbox, click the document in the list on the left, then click View Document to see the original on screen.
47. Click Process with AI. It reads the file (free on your PC first; AI only for scans or photos), works out what the document is, and drafts the voucher(s) below - the status line shows "Reading the document..." while it works.
48. Check the draft against the document - party, amounts, GST, and the accounts it chose.
49. Click Accept & Post Selected to record it in your books, or Reject if it is wrong.

NOTE: Bank statements are treated specially - they are NOT auto-posted into your day-to-day entry. They are set aside for you to bring in under Bank Reconciliation (section 18), where matching belongs.

How you stay in control

- Nothing posts on its own - every AI draft waits for your Accept & Post Selected.
- Every voucher the AI made is tagged as AI-created and carries a confidence score, so you can always see what came from the AI versus what you typed.
- The original document stays linked, so an approved voucher can always be traced back to its source.

The AI Document Reader

This is the same engine for a single document on demand. Open AI > AI Document Reader, pick one file, and it reads and drafts it without going through the inbox queue - handy for a one-off bill.

20. Verbal / quick entry

Describe a transaction in plain words and let the AI draft the voucher for you to confirm and post. (An AI feature - uses your key.)

21. Moving over from Tally / Excel / Zoho

Open Data > Migration to bring your chart of accounts into Accounts HQ from:

- Tally (export your masters to XML),
- an Excel chart of accounts, or
- a Zoho Books / QuickBooks CSV.

A wizard previews exactly what will be imported before anything is applied, so you can check it first. (Pulling mid-year Tally transactions over a live connection is planned for a future release.)

22. Backup and restore - do this regularly

Your data lives on this PC, so a backup is your insurance against a disk failure, theft or a mistake.

50. Open Data > Backup & Restore.

51. Click Backup and save the file somewhere safe - a pen-drive or a cloud folder (Google Drive, OneDrive).

52. To recover, click Restore and choose your backup file.

TIP: Make a habit of it - for example a backup every Friday, and before any big change.

23. Settings and preferences

- Theme - Dark or Light (sidebar toggle).
- Debit/Credit wording - plain, traditional or accounting style, if the words confuse you.
- Default voucher date - "today" each time, or "last used" so the date sticks across entries (sticky date is available on Standard and above).

Staying up to date

Accounts HQ checks for a newer version when it starts and tells you when one is available, so you can download the update in a click. You can also check any time from Settings.

24. Plans, transaction limits, licence and upgrading

The four plans

- FREE - core book-keeping, single user, a capped number of transactions.
- STANDARD - reports, exports, bank/ledger reconciliation, receivables & payables aging, multi-party vouchers, sticky date, 2 users.
- PRO - adds GST, TDS, the AI Document Inbox/Reader, bill-by-bill referencing and cash-flow planning, 5 users.
- PREMIUM - everything, including WhatsApp, audit export and API access, 10 users.

Entering your licence

Open the Licence page (Account section) and paste the key we emailed you. The app then unlocks the features for your plan.

Transaction limits

Each plan includes a transaction allowance. Free/Demo are hard-capped; paid plans allow overage (extra transactions at a small per-transaction rate) so work never stops mid-month - you are warned before any overage applies.

Upgrading your plan

Moving up a tier is in-place - you keep the same key and pay only the difference for your remaining term:

53. Go to apps.ai-consultants.in/upgrade.html.
54. Enter your existing licence key. You see the upgrade price (the new plan price minus credit for the unused part of your current licence).
55. Pay. Your existing key is upgraded instantly to the new plan, with a fresh full term.

25. Troubleshooting and FAQ

It says "Limit reached" when I try to post.

You have used your plan transaction allowance. Upgrade your plan (section 24), or on paid plans accept the small overage to continue.

The GST / AI / aging screens are locked.

Those features need a higher plan (and AI needs your own Anthropic key). See section 24.

The AI says it needs a key.

Open Settings > AI and paste your own Anthropic API key (section 19).

I made a mistake in a voucher.

Open Day Book, find it, and Edit or Cancel it (section 11).

My PC died / I am moving to a new computer.

Install Accounts HQ on the new PC and use Restore with your latest backup file (section 22). This is why regular backups matter.

Email connection will not work.

Most providers need an "app password" (not your normal password). The Email setup screen has per-provider help; on Pro/Premium we can set it up for you.

Where is my data stored?

In a per-company file on this PC under your Windows profile. Use Backup & Restore rather than copying raw files.

26. Glossary

- **Ledger** - An account you track, e.g. Cash, a bank, a customer, an expense.
- **Group** - A folder that organises ledgers (e.g. Sundry Debtors holds all customers).
- **Voucher** - One recorded transaction (payment, receipt, sale, etc.).
- **Debit / Credit (Dr/Cr)** - The two equal sides of every voucher.
- **Receivable** - Money customers owe you.

- **Payable** - Money you owe suppliers.
- **On-account** - A receipt/payment not yet tied to a specific invoice.
- **Aging** - How old an outstanding amount is (0-30, 31-60, 61-90, 90+ days).
- **GSTIN** - Your GST registration number.
- **CGST/SGST/IGST** - GST split: CGST+SGST within a state, IGST across states.
- **TDS** - Tax Deducted at Source on certain payments.
- **Reconciliation** - Matching your books against a bank or party statement.
- **Narration** - A free-text note on a voucher.
- **Chart of accounts** - The full set of your groups and ledgers.

27. Keyboard shortcuts

- Alt + C - open the calculator.
- Click the logo - go to the Home dashboard.

28. Support and contact

We are here to help.

- Email: info@ai-consultants.in
- Website: apps.ai-consultants.in
- Upgrade: apps.ai-consultants.in/upgrade.html

Pro and Premium plans include hands-on setup help - connecting your email and scanner, adding your AI key, and migrating from your old software.

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